

US Patent & Trademark Office

Patent Public Search | Text View

United States Patent	12417395
Kind Code	B2
Date of Patent	September 16, 2025
Inventor(s)	Gaebler; John et al.

Decreased crosstalk atomic object detection

Abstract

Various embodiments provide methods, apparatuses, systems, or computer program products for performing decreased crosstalk atomic object reading/detection. A controller is operatively connected to components of a system comprising a confinement apparatus comprising RF electrodes defining an RF null axis and a plurality of longitudinal electrodes. The components comprise voltage sources and manipulation sources. The controller is configured to cause an atomic object being read and neighboring atomic object(s) to be confined by the confinement apparatus; and cause the voltage sources to provide first control signals to longitudinal electrodes. The first control signals cause the longitudinal electrodes to generate a push field configured to cause one of the atomic object being read or the neighboring atomic object(s) to move off the RF null axis. The controller is further configured to cause a manipulation source to generate/provide a reading beam that is at least partly incident on the atomic object being read.

Inventors:	Gaebler; John (Golden, CO), Neyenhuis; Brian (Broomfield, CO)
Applicant:	Quantinuum LLC (Broomfield, CO)
Family ID:	1000008820200
Assignee:	Quantinuum LLC (Broomfield, CO)
Appl. No.:	18/618543
Filed:	March 27, 2024

Prior Publication Data

Document Identifier	Publication Date
US 20250036985 A1	Jan. 30, 2025

Related U.S. Application Data

continuation parent-doc US 17393011 20210803 US 11972322 child-doc US 18618543

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: G06N10/00 (20220101); H04B10/70 (20130101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC G06N10/00 (20190101); H04B10/70 (20130101);

Field of Classification Search

CPC: G06N (10/00); H04B (10/70)

References Cited

U.S. PATENT DOCUMENTS

Patent No.	Issued Date	Patentee Name	U.S. Cl.	CPC
10733524	12/2019	Feig et al.	N/A	N/A
11972322	12/2023	Gaebler et al.	N/A	N/A
2019/0065981	12/2018	Chen et al.	N/A	N/A
2019/0376790	12/2018	Barrett et al.	N/A	N/A
2020/0125987	12/2019	Bishop et al.	N/A	N/A
2021/0088387	12/2020	Bonifas et al.	N/A	N/A

FOREIGN PATENT DOCUMENTS

Patent No.	Application Date	Country	CPC
107636433	12/2017	CN	N/A
108805293	12/2017	CN	N/A
109211414	12/2018	CN	N/A
111183432	12/2019	CN	N/A

OTHER PUBLICATIONS

Bruzewicz Colin D. et al: “Trapped-ion quantum computing: Progress and challenges”, Applied Physics Reviews, vol. 6, No. 2, Apr. 8, 2019 (Apr. 8, 2019), p. 021314, XP055798038, DOI: 10.1063/1.5088164 Retrieved from the Internet: URL:<https://arxiv.org/pdf/1904.04178.pdf>. cited by applicant

EP Office Action Mailed on May 7, 2024 for EP Application No. 21200367, 8 page(s). cited by applicant

Extended European search report Mailed on Mar. 4, 2022 for EP Application No. 21200367, 12 page. cited by applicant

Leibfried D: “Individual addressing and state readout of trapped ions utilizing rf- micromotion”, arxiv.org, Cornell University Library, 201 Olin Library Cornell University Ithaca, NY 14853, Dec. 15, 1998 (Dec. 15, 1998), XP080648693. cited by applicant

Leibfried, D., “Individual addressing and state readout of trapped ions utilizing rf- micromotion”, submitted Dec. 15, 1998, Physical Review A, [online, article] retrieved from the Internet at <<https://arxiv.org/pdf/quant-ph/9812033.pdf>> on Feb. 10, 2022, 8 pages. cited by applicant

Notice of Allowance and Fees Due (PTOL-85) Mailed on Jan. 5, 2024 for U.S. Appl. No. 17/393,011, 8 page(s). cited by applicant

Cai, Xunming, “Electromagnetically Induced Transparency of Four-Level Atomic System in a

Field of Time-Varying Frequency”, ACTA Optica Sinica, Jan. 2011, 17 pages (including translation), vol. 31, No. 1, Chinese Optical Society, China. cited by applicant
CN Office Action, including Search Report Mailed on Oct. 31, 2024 for CN Application No. 202111173758, 7 page(s). cited by applicant
English Translation of CN Office Action, including Search Report dated Oct. 31, 2024 for CN Application No. 202111173758, 14 page(s). cited by applicant
Ming, Shi, et al., “Research of all-optical Cs atomic magnetometer by using modulation of laser's polarization”, Infrared and Laser Engineering, Sep. 2018, 8 pages (including Machine Translation), vol. 47, No. 9, Chinese Society for Optical Engineering, China. cited by applicant
CN Notice of Allowance, including Search Report Mailed on Mar. 17, 2025 for CN Application No. 202111173758, 4 page(s). cited by applicant
English Translation of CN Notice of Allowance, including Search Report dated Mar 17, 2025 for CN Application No. 202111173758, 5 page(s). cited by applicant
Mundada, Pranav, et al., “Suppression of Qubit Crosstalk in a Tunable Coupling Superconducting Circuit”, Physical Review Applied, Nov. 11, 2019, 11 pages, vol. 12., No. 054023, American Physical Society, US. cited by applicant
Communication about intention to grant a European patent Mailed on Jun. 18, 2025 for EP Application No. 21200367, 6 page(s). cited by applicant

Primary Examiner: Stoffa; Wyatt A

Assistant Examiner: Chang; Hanway

Attorney, Agent or Firm: Alston & Bird LLP

Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This application is a continuation of U.S. application Ser. No. 17/393,011, filed Aug. 3, 2021, which claims priority to U.S. Application No. 63/088,064, filed Oct. 6, 2020, the content of which is hereby incorporated by reference in its entirety.

TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) Various embodiments relate to apparatuses, systems, and methods relating to detecting and/or reading atomic objects within an atomic object confinement apparatus. For example, some example embodiments relate to the detection and/or reading of a qubit of a quantum computer.

BACKGROUND

(2) Quantum computing is the use of quantum phenomena such as superposition and entanglement to perform computation. In particular, quantum bits (qubits) are acted on to cause and/or control evolution of quantum states of the qubits to perform one or more calculations. To determine the result of the one or more calculations, the quantum state of one or more of the qubits needs to be read and/or detected. However, crosstalk errors may occur when a qubit neighboring a qubit to be read and/or detected is decohered or otherwise disturbed during the reading and/or detecting of the qubit to be read and/or detected. Through applied effort, ingenuity, and innovation many deficiencies of such prior reading and/or detection techniques have been solved by developing solutions that are structured in accordance with the embodiments of the present invention, many examples of which are described in detail herein.

BRIEF SUMMARY OF EXAMPLE EMBODIMENTS

(3) Example embodiments provide methods, systems, apparatuses, computer program products

and/or the like for reducing crosstalk during an atomic object reading and/or detection function. Various embodiments correspond to a quantum computer, such as a trapped atomic object quantum computer, for example, and performing qubit reading and/or detection functions in a manner that reduces and/or suppresses crosstalk errors. For example, the qubit of the quantum computer may be an atom and/or ion, which may be part of an atom and/or ion crystal and/or group. In various embodiments, the atomic object is trapped and/or confined within an atomic object confinement apparatus, such as an ion trap, a surface ion trap, and/or the like. The qubit may be read and/or detected by providing a reading beam (e.g., a laser beam that has a frequency/wavelength that is resonant with a particular quantum transition of the atomic object being used as the qubit) that is incident upon the qubit (e.g., atomic object) to be read. For example, when the qubit (e.g., atomic object) fluoresces in response to the reading beam being incident thereon, the qubit is in one state (e.g., state 1) and when the qubit (e.g., atomic object) does not fluoresce in response to the reading beam being incident thereon, the qubit is in another state (e.g., state 0). For example, the reading beam may be configured to stimulate emission of a particular frequency/wavelength by the qubit (e.g., atomic object) when the qubit is in a particular state and not stimulate emission of the particular frequency/wavelength if the qubit is not in the particular state.

(4) However, photons from the reading beam and/or the stimulated emission emitted by the qubit being read and/or detected may be incident on neighboring qubits (e.g., atomic objects). As used herein, a neighboring qubit (e.g., atomic object) is a qubit (e.g. atomic object) that neighbors and/or is adjacent to the qubit to be read and/or detected and/or that is close enough to the qubit being read and/or detected that photons from the reading beam and/or the stimulated emission emitted by the qubit being read and/or detected (or another neighboring qubit) may be incident thereon. Various embodiments of the present disclosure relate to reducing crosstalk errors caused by neighboring qubits having incident thereon photons from the reading beam and/or the stimulated emission emitted by the qubit being read and/or detected (or another neighboring qubit). For example, in various embodiments, the absorption of photons from the reading beam and/or the stimulated emission emitted by the qubit being read and/or detected (or another neighboring qubit) by neighboring qubits is suppressed. In various embodiments, small amplitude oscillations are imparted to a neighboring qubit (e.g., atomic object) and/or the qubit (e.g., atomic object) being read and/or detected such that a photon having a frequency/wavelength resonant with the qubit being read and/or detected is off-resonance for any neighboring qubits.

(5) According to a first aspect, a method for a decreased crosstalk atomic object reading and/or detection function is provided. In an example embodiment, the method comprises providing at least two atomic objects within a confinement apparatus. The at least two atomic objects comprise an atomic object being read and at least one neighboring atomic object. The confinement apparatus comprises (a) one or more radio frequency (RF) electrodes defining an RF null axis of the atomic object confinement apparatus and (b) a plurality of longitudinal electrodes. The method further comprises causing at least one voltage source to provide at least one first control signal to at least one longitudinal electrode of the plurality of longitudinal electrodes. The at least one first control signal causes the at least one longitudinal electrode to generate a push field configured to cause one of (a) the at least one neighboring atomic object to move in a direction transverse to the RF null axis at a location of the at least one neighboring atomic object or (b) the atomic object being read to move in a direction transverse to the RF null axis at a location of the atomic object being read. The method further comprises causing a manipulation source to generate and provide a reading beam that is incident at least in part on the atomic object being read.

(6) In an example embodiment, the method further comprises beginning to execute a quantum circuit using the at least two atomic objects within the atomic object confinement apparatus; during the performance of the quantum circuit, identifying a read function to be performed, wherein the causing of the at least one first control signal to be provided to the at least one longitudinal electrode and the causing of the manipulation source to generate and provide the reading beam are

performed responsive to identifying the read function to be performed; and continuing to execute the quantum circuit. In an example embodiment, the method further comprises receiving a read result responsive to the reading beam being incident at least in part on the atomic object being read; and adjusting the quantum circuit based at least in part on the read result such that the adjusted quantum circuit is executed. In an example embodiment, the method further comprises causing at least one second control signal to be provided to one or more longitudinal electrodes of the plurality of longitudinal electrodes, wherein the at least one second control signal causes the one or more longitudinal electrodes to generate an oscillating potential configured to cause the at least one neighboring atomic object to oscillate in a direction substantially parallel to a direction between the at least one neighboring atomic object and the atomic object being read.

(7) In an example embodiment, the at least one first control signal is configured to cause the push field to increase monotonically to a maximum field strength and then decrease monotonically to a minimum field strength. In an example embodiment, the maximum field strength is in a range of 1050 to 1250 Volts per meter. In an example embodiment, as the field strength decreases from the maximum field strength to the minimum field strength, the at least one neighboring atomic object moves toward the RF null axis. In an example embodiment, when the one of (a) the at least one neighboring atomic object or (b) the atomic object being read is located off of the RF null axis, the one of (a) the at least one neighboring atomic object or (b) the atomic object being read exhibits oscillations in a direction transverse to the RF null axis at the location of the at least one neighboring atomic object. In an example embodiment, when the atomic object being read is located off of the RF null axis, a frequency of the reading beam is modulated so that in an oscillating reference frame of the atomic object being read, the frequency of the reading beam is on resonance for a particular transition of the atomic object being read. In an example embodiment, in a reference frame of the at least one neighboring atomic object, a frequency of the reading beam is off resonant with a particular transition of the at least one neighboring atomic object.

(8) In an example embodiment, the method is performed by a controller of a system comprising the confinement apparatus, voltage sources, and manipulation sources. In an example embodiment, a processing device of the controller executes executable instructions stored by a memory of the controller to cause the controller to perform the method. In an example embodiment, the system is a quantum computer. In an example embodiment, the quantum computer is a trapped ion quantum computer and the confinement apparatus is an ion trap, such as a surface ion trap.

(9) According to another aspect of the present disclosure, a controller is provided. The controller is operatively connected to one or more components of a system comprising a confinement apparatus. The confinement apparatus comprises (a) one or more radio frequency (RF) electrodes defining an RF null axis of the atomic object confinement apparatus and (b) a plurality of longitudinal electrodes. The one or more components of the system comprise (a) voltage sources and (b) manipulation sources. In an example embodiment, the controller is configured to cause at least two atomic objects to be confined within the confinement apparatus, the at least two atomic objects comprising an atomic object being read and at least one neighboring atomic object; and cause the voltage sources to provide at least one first control signal to at least one longitudinal electrode of the plurality of longitudinal electrodes. The at least one first control signal causes the at least one longitudinal electrode to generate a push field configured to cause one of (a) the at least one neighboring atomic object to move in a direction transverse to the RF null axis at a location of the at least one neighboring atomic object or (b) the atomic object being read to move in a direction transverse to the RF null axis at a location of the atomic object being read. The controller is further configured to cause a manipulation source to generate and provide a reading beam that is incident at least in part on the atomic object being read.

(10) In an example embodiment, the controller is further configured to control the one or more components to cause a quantum circuit to begin to be performed using the at least two atomic objects within the atomic object confinement apparatus; during the performance of the quantum

circuit, identify a read function to be performed, wherein the causing of the voltage sources to provide the at least one first control signal to the at least one longitudinal electrode and the causing of the manipulation source to generate and provide the reading beam are performed responsive to identifying the read function to be performed; and control the one or more components to cause the quantum circuit to continue to be performed. In an example embodiment, the controller is further configured to receive a read result responsive to the reading beam being incident at least in part on the atomic object being read; and adjust the quantum circuit based at least in part on the read result such that the adjusted quantum circuit is executed. In an example embodiment, the controller is further configured to cause the voltage sources to provide at least one second control signal to one or more longitudinal electrodes of the plurality of longitudinal electrodes, wherein the at least one second control signal causes the one or more longitudinal electrodes to generate an oscillating potential configured to cause the at least one neighboring atomic object to oscillate in a direction substantially parallel to a direction between the at least one neighboring atomic object and the atomic object being read.

(11) In an example embodiment, the at least one first control signal is configured to cause the push field to increase monotonically to a maximum field strength and then decrease monotonically to a minimum field strength. In an example embodiment, the maximum field strength is in a range of 1050 to 1250 Volts per meter. In an example embodiment, as the field strength decreases from the maximum field strength to the minimum field strength, the at least one neighboring atomic object moves toward the RF null axis. In an example embodiment, when the one of (a) the at least one neighboring atomic object or (b) the atomic object being read is located off of the RF null axis, the one of (a) the at least one neighboring atomic object or (b) the atomic object being read exhibits oscillations in a direction transverse to the RF null axis. In an example embodiment, when the atomic object being read is located off of the RF null axis, the controller causes the manipulation source to modulate a frequency of the reading so that in an oscillating reference frame of the atomic object being read, the frequency of the reading beam is on resonance for a particular transition of the atomic object being read. In an example embodiment, in a reference frame of the at least one neighboring atomic object, a frequency of the reading beam is off resonant with a particular transition of the at least one neighboring atomic object.

(12) In an example embodiment, the controller is part of the system comprising the confinement apparatus, voltage sources, and manipulation sources. In an example embodiment, a processing device of the controller executes executable instructions stored by a memory of the controller to cause the controller to control the voltage sources and manipulation sources to confine the at least two atomic objects in the confinement apparatus via a confinement potential, provide the at least one first control signal to the at least one longitudinal electrode, and generate and provide the reading beam. In an example embodiment, the system is a quantum computer. In an example embodiment, the quantum computer is a trapped ion quantum computer and the confinement apparatus is an ion trap, such as a surface ion trap. In an example embodiment, a filter configured to filter frequencies greater than a cut-off frequency from being provided to a longitudinal electrode is configured to pass the second control signal to the longitudinal electrode, wherein the second control signal has a frequency that is greater than the cut-off frequency.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE SEVERAL VIEWS OF THE DRAWING(S)

- (1) Having thus described the invention in general terms, reference will now be made to the accompanying drawings, which are not necessarily drawn to scale, and wherein:
- (2) FIG. 1 is a schematic diagram of a reading and/or detection function.
- (3) FIG. 2 is a schematic diagram of a decreased crosstalk reading and/or detection function in

accordance with an example embodiment.

(4) FIG. 3 is a schematic diagram of another decreased crosstalk reading and/or detection function in accordance with an example embodiment.

(5) FIG. 4 provides a top view of an example atomic object confinement apparatus that may be used in example embodiment.

(6) FIG. 5 is a flowchart of various processes, procedures, and/or operations that may be performed, for example, by a controller of the atomic object confinement apparatus, to perform a decreased crosstalk reading and/or detection function, in accordance with an example embodiment.

(7) FIGS. 6A and 6B provide plots showing the effect of the field strength of a push field that may be applied to a neighboring qubit (e.g., atomic object) and/or a qubit being read and/or detect, according to some example embodiments.

(8) FIG. 7 is a schematic diagram of another decreased crosstalk reading and/or detection function in accordance with an example embodiment.

(9) FIG. 8 is a flowchart of various processes, procedures, and/or operations that may be performed, for example, by a controller of the atomic object confinement apparatus, to perform a decreased crosstalk reading and/or detection function, in accordance with an example embodiment.

(10) FIG. 9 is a schematic diagram illustrating an example quantum computing system configured to perform one or more decreased crosstalk reading and/or detection functions, according to various embodiments.

(11) FIG. 10 provides a schematic diagram of an example controller of a quantum computer configured to perform one or more decreased crosstalk reading and/or detection functions, according to various embodiments.

(12) FIG. 11 provides a schematic diagram of an example computing entity of a quantum computer system that may be used in accordance with an example embodiment.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF SOME EXAMPLE EMBODIMENTS

(13) The present invention now will be described more fully hereinafter with reference to the accompanying drawings, in which some, but not all embodiments of the invention are shown. Indeed, the invention may be embodied in many different forms and should not be construed as limited to the embodiments set forth herein; rather, these embodiments are provided so that this disclosure will satisfy applicable legal requirements. The term “or” (also denoted “/”) is used herein in both the alternative and conjunctive sense, unless otherwise indicated. The terms “illustrative” and “exemplary” are used to be examples with no indication of quality level. The terms “generally,” “substantially,” and “approximately” refer to within engineering and/or manufacturing tolerances and/or within user measurement capabilities, unless otherwise indicated. Like numbers refer to like elements throughout.

(14) In various embodiments, methods, apparatuses, systems, computer program products, and/or the like for performing various reduced crosstalk reading and/or detection functions. In various embodiments, at least two atomic objects are confined within an atomic object confinement apparatus (also referred to as a confinement apparatus herein). In various embodiments, the atomic objects are ions or atoms. In various embodiments, the atomic object may be part of an atom or ion crystal comprising a qubit atomic object (e.g. a qubit ion) and a sympathetic cooling (SC) atomic object (e.g., SC ion). In various embodiments, the confinement apparatus is a trap or other apparatus configured to confine the atomic objects. For example, in an example embodiment, the atomic objects are ions and the confinement apparatus is an ion trap (e.g., a surface ion trap).

(15) In various embodiments, the confinement apparatus is configured to enable the performance of a reading and/or detection function. In particular, a reading and/or detection function may be used to determine whether an atomic object is in a particular quantum state or not. FIG. 1 provides a schematic top view of an example reading and/or detection function. Atomic objects **110** (e.g., **110A**, **110B**) are confined within a confinement region **100** of a confinement apparatus. The example confinement apparatus comprises at least one radio frequency (RF) electrode and a

plurality of longitudinal electrodes. In various embodiments, the at least one RF electrode generates a trapping field configured to confine the atomic objects **110** within the confinement region **100** of the confinement apparatus. The at least one RF electrode defines an RF null axis **105** of the confinement region **100**. In an example embodiment, the RF null axis **105** is the longitudinal axis of at least a portion of the confinement region **100**. In general, the atomic objects **110** are located along the RF null axis **105**. A reading beam **115** may be provided to the confinement region **100** such that the reading beam **115** is at least partially incident on the atomic object being read and/or detected **110A**. In various embodiments, the reading beam **115** is incident on the atomic object read and/or detected at a reading incident angle α . In various embodiments, the reading beam **115** is a laser beam that is characterized by a frequency/wavelength that is resonant with a particular transition of the atomic object being read and/or detected **110A**. For example, the particular transition may be from a first state (e.g., qubit state 1) to another state (e.g., qubit state 0 or another quantum state of the atomic object). When the reading beam **115** is incident on the atomic object being read and/or detected **110A** and the atomic object is in the first state, the atomic object being read and/or detected **110A** fluoresces by emitting stimulated emission **120**. In various embodiments, the stimulated emission **120** is emitted by atomic object being read and/or detected **110A** at a variety of emission angles θ . At least some of the stimulated emission **120** is detected by detector **125**. In various embodiments, the detector **125** is in communication with a controller and/or other computing entity configured to receive an indication of the detection of the stimulated emission **120** by the detector **125**.

(16) However, photons from the reading beam **115** and/or the stimulated emission **120** may be incident on neighboring atomic object(s) **110B**. In various embodiments, the neighboring atomic objects **110B** and the atomic object being read and/or detected are the same species of atomic objects and therefore have the same atomic structures. Thus, a neighboring atomic object may absorb a photon of the reading beam **115** and/or stimulated emission **120** and thereby corrupt the quantum information stored by the neighboring atomic object (e.g., the qubit may be decohered and/or the like). As used herein, a neighboring atomic object **110B** is an atomic object that neighbors and/or is adjacent to the atomic object being read and/or detected **110A** and/or that is close enough to the atomic object being read and/or detected **110A** that photons from the reading beam **115** and/or the stimulated emission **120** may be incident thereon. In various embodiments, a push field and/or an oscillating potential may be generated (e.g., via application of control signals to the at least RF electrode and/or at least one of the plurality of longitudinal electrodes) and experienced by one of the neighboring atomic object(s) **110B** or the atomic object to be read and/or detected **110A** to cause the atomic object experiencing the push field and/or the oscillating potential to oscillate and/or experience a small back and forth motion that causes suppression of absorption of photons from the reading beam **115** and/or stimulated emission **120** by the neighboring atomic object(s) **110B**. In particular, the oscillations and/or small back and forth motion of the atomic object experiencing the push field and/or oscillating potential causes the reading beam **115** and/or stimulated emission **120** to be off-resonance for the neighboring atomic object(s) **110B**. In other words, in various embodiments, the oscillations and/or small back and forth motion of the atomic object experiencing the push field and/or oscillating potential causes the reading beam **115** and/or stimulated emission **120** to be characterized by a frequency/wavelength that is not resonant with the particular transition of the neighboring atomic object(s) **110B**. For example, FIG. 2 provides a schematic diagram of a neighboring atomic object **110B** experiencing a push field **130**, FIG. 3 provides a schematic diagram of a neighboring atomic object **110B** experiencing an oscillating potential **145**, and FIG. 7 provides a schematic diagram of an atomic object to be read and/or detected **100A** experiencing a push field **130** and having a modulated reading beam **115'** incident thereon, in accordance with various embodiments of the present disclosure.

(17) As absorption of photons from the reading beam **115** and/or stimulated emission **120** is suppressed in various embodiments, the crosstalk between the neighboring atomic object(s) **110B**

and the atomic object being read and/or detected **110A** is reduced. In an example embodiment, the absorption of photons from the reading beam **115** and/or stimulated emission **120** is suppressed by at least a factor of ten. In an example embodiment, the absorption of photons from the reading beam **115** and/or stimulated emission **120** is suppressed by at least a factor of twenty. In an example embodiment, the absorption of photons from the reading beam **115** and/or stimulated emission **120** is suppressed by a factor of approximately 30. In an example embodiment, the absorption of photons from the reading beam **115** and/or stimulated emission **120** is completely (e.g., 100%) suppressed.

Exemplary Atomic Object Confinement Apparatus

(18) FIG. **4** provides a top view of an example confinement apparatus **400** that may be used to confine the at least two atomic objects **110**. For example, in an example embodiment, the confinement apparatus is an ion trap (e.g., a surface ion trap) and the atomic objects are ions. In an example embodiment, the confinement apparatus **100** (e.g., surface ion trap) is fabricated as part of an ion trap chip and/or part of an ion trap apparatus and/or package. In an example embodiment, the confinement apparatus **400** is at least partially defined by a number of RF electrodes **412** (e.g., **412A**, **412B**). In various embodiments, the confinement apparatus **400** is at least partially defined by a number of sequences of longitudinal electrodes **414** (e.g., **414A**, **414B**, **414C**). Each sequence of longitudinal electrodes **414** comprises a plurality of longitudinal electrodes **416**. In an example embodiment, each longitudinal electrode **416** and/or at least a non-empty subset of the longitudinal electrodes **416** may be operated independently via the application of control signals thereto. In an example embodiment, the confinement apparatus **400** is a surface Paul trap with symmetric RF electrodes **412**. In various embodiments, the RF electrodes **412** and the longitudinal electrodes **416** generate potentials and/or fields that are experienced by atomic objects **110** within a confinement region **100** of the confinement apparatus **400**. In particular, the RF electrodes **412** may be configured to define the confinement region **100** of the confinement apparatus **400** and the longitudinal electrodes **416** may be configured to at least partially control movement and/or motion of atomic objects within the confinement region **100**.

(19) In various embodiments, the upper surface of the confinement apparatus **400** has a planarized topology. For example, the upper surface of each RF electrode **412** of the number of RF electrodes **412** and the upper surface of each longitudinal electrode **416** of the number of sequences of longitudinal electrodes **414** may be substantially coplanar.

(20) In various embodiments, the confinement apparatus **400** comprises and/or is at least partially defined by a number of RF electrodes **412**. The RF electrodes **412** are formed with substantially parallel longitudinal axes **411** (e.g., **411A**, **411B**) and with substantially coplanar upper surfaces. For example, the RF electrodes **412** are substantially parallel such that a distance between the RF electrodes **412** is approximately constant along the length of the RF electrodes **412** (e.g., the length of an RF electrode being along the longitudinal axes **411** of RF electrode **412**). For example, the upper surfaces of the RF electrodes **412** may be substantially flush with the upper surface of the confinement apparatus **400**. In an example embodiment, the number of RF electrodes **412** comprises two RF electrodes **412** (e.g., **412A**, **412B**). In various embodiments, the confinement apparatus **400** may comprise a plurality of number of RF electrodes **412**. For example, the confinement apparatus **400** may be a two-dimensional ion trap that comprises multiple numbers (e.g., pairs and/or sets) of RF electrodes **412** with each number (e.g., pair and/or set) of RF electrodes **412** having substantially parallel longitudinal axes **411**. In an example embodiment, a first number of RF electrodes **412** have mutually substantially parallel longitudinal axes **411**, a second number of RF electrodes **412** have mutually substantially parallel longitudinal axes **411**, and the longitudinal axes of the first number of RF electrodes and the longitudinal axes of the second number of RF electrodes are substantially non-parallel (e.g., transverse). FIG. **4** illustrates an example one dimensional confinement apparatus **400** and/or a portion of a two dimensional confinement apparatus **400** having two RF electrodes **412**, though other embodiments may

comprise additional RF electrodes in various configurations.

(21) In various embodiments, two adjacent RF electrodes **412** may be separated (e.g., insulated) from one another by a longitudinal gap. In various embodiments, the confinement region **100** is at least partially over the longitudinal gap. For example, the longitudinal gap may define (in one or two dimensions) the confinement region **100**. In various embodiments, the confinement region **100** may extend substantially parallel to the longitudinal axes **411** of the adjacent RF electrodes **412**. For example, the longitudinal gap may extend substantially parallel to the x-axis as shown in FIGS. **1-4**. In an example embodiment, the longitudinal gap may be at least partially filled with an insulating material (e.g., a dielectric material). In various embodiments, the dielectric material may be silicon dioxide (e.g., formed through thermal oxidation) and/or other dielectric and/or insulating material. In various embodiments, the longitudinal gap has a height (e.g., in the y-direction) of approximately 40 μm to 500 μm . In various embodiments, one or more sequences of longitudinal electrodes **414** (e.g., a second sequence of longitudinal electrodes **414B**) may be disposed and/or formed within the longitudinal gap.

(22) In an example embodiment, a transverse gap may exist between neighboring and/or adjacent longitudinal electrodes **416** of the one or more sequences of electrodes **414**. In an example embodiment, the transverse gap may be empty space and/or at least partially filled with a dielectric material to prevent electrical communication between neighboring and/or adjacent electrodes. In an example embodiment, the transverse gap between neighboring and/or adjacent electrodes may be in the range of approximately 1-10 μm .

(23) In an example embodiment, a longitudinal gap exists between a sequence of longitudinal electrodes **414** and a neighboring and/or adjacent RF electrode **412**. In an example embodiment, the longitudinal gap may be at least partially filled with a dielectric and/or insulating material to prevent electrical communication between longitudinal electrodes **416** of the sequence of electrodes **414** and the RF electrode **412**. In an example embodiment, the longitudinal gap between neighboring and/or adjacent electrodes may be in the range of approximately 1-10 μm .

(24) In various embodiments, the confinement apparatus **400** may be at least partially defined by a number of sequences of longitudinal electrodes **414** (e.g., first sequence of longitudinal electrodes **414A**, second sequence of longitudinal electrodes **414B**, third sequence of longitudinal electrodes **414C**). Each sequence of longitudinal electrodes **414** is formed to extend substantially parallel to the substantially parallel longitudinal axes **411** of the RF electrodes **412**. For example, the number of sequences of longitudinal electrodes **414** may extend substantially parallel to the x-axis as shown in FIG. **4**. In various embodiments, the number of sequences of longitudinal electrodes **414** comprises two, three, four, and/or another number of sequences of longitudinal electrodes **414**. In an example embodiment, the confinement apparatus **400** comprises a plurality of number of sequences of longitudinal electrodes **414**. For example, the illustrated confinement apparatus **400** is a one-dimensional ion trap comprising three sequences of longitudinal electrodes **414**. For example, the confinement apparatus **400** may be a two-dimensional ion trap that comprises multiple numbers of sequences of longitudinal electrodes **414** that each extend substantially parallel to a substantially parallel longitudinal axes of a corresponding number of RF electrodes **412**. In an example embodiment, a first number of sequences of longitudinal electrodes **414** extend substantially parallel to the substantially parallel longitudinal axes **411** of a first number of RF electrodes **412**, a second number of sequences of longitudinal electrodes **414** extend substantially parallel to the substantially parallel longitudinal axes **411** of a second number of RF electrodes **412**, and the longitudinal axes of the first number of RF electrodes and the longitudinal axes of the second number of RF electrodes are substantially non-parallel (e.g., transverse). In some embodiments, each of the longitudinal electrodes **416** of the number of sequences of longitudinal electrodes **414** can be formed with substantially coplanar upper surfaces that are substantially coplanar with the upper surfaces of the RF electrodes **412**.

(25) In an example embodiment (e.g., as illustrated in FIG. **4**), a number (e.g., pair) of RF

electrodes **412** may be formed between a first sequence of longitudinal electrodes **414A** and a third sequence of longitudinal electrodes **414C** with a second sequence of longitudinal electrodes **414B** extending along the longitudinal gap between the RF electrodes **412**. For example, each sequence of longitudinal electrodes **414** may extend in a direction substantially parallel to the longitudinal axes **411** of the RF electrodes **412** (e.g., in the x-direction). In various embodiments, the upper surfaces of the sequences of longitudinal electrodes **414** are substantially coplanar with the upper surfaces of the RF electrodes **412**.

(26) In various embodiments, RF signals may be applied to the RF electrodes **412** to generate an electric and/or magnetic field that acts to maintain an atomic object (e.g., ion) trapped within the confinement apparatus **400** in directions transverse to the longitudinal direction of the confinement apparatus **400** (e.g., the y- and z-directions). In various embodiments, control signals and/or voltages are applied to the longitudinal electrodes **416** to generate a desired electric potential field within the confinement region **100**. For example, in various embodiments, time-dependent, time-varying, time evolving, and/or non-static direct current (DC) voltages may be applied to the longitudinal electrodes **416** to generate a time-dependent, time-varying, time evolving, and/or non-static electric potential field that causes the atomic objects trapped within the confinement apparatus **400** to traverse corresponding trajectories to within the confinement region **100**. For example, the atomic objects may be moved between various zones of the confinement apparatus **400** such that various functions may be performed thereon. For example, the atomic objects may be initialized, gated via single qubit gates, gated via double/multiple qubit gates, transported and/or stored, read and/or detected, and/or the like. In an example embodiment, the longitudinal electrodes **416** are configured to, responsive to control signals applied thereto, generate push fields and/or oscillating potentials configured to cause an atomic object experiencing the push field and/or oscillating potential to experience oscillations and/or small back and forth movements. In various embodiments, a push field **130** is configured to push an atomic object off of the RF null axis **105** (which is co-located with the longitudinal axis **405** of the confinement region **100** in an example embodiment) of the confinement apparatus **400**. An atomic object pushed off of the RF null axis **105** will experience a potential (e.g., at least partially generated by application of the RF signal to the RF electrodes **412**) that causes the atomic object to oscillate and/or experience small back and forth motions in a direction transverse (e.g., perpendicular, in an example embodiment) to the RF null axis **105** at the location of the atomic object along the RF null axis **105**/longitudinal axis **405** of the confinement apparatus **400**. For example, pushing an atomic object radially away from the RF null axis **105** (e.g., in a y-z plane) will experience a potential that causes the atomic object to oscillate and/or experience small back and forth motions in a radial direction of the confinement region (e.g., in the y direction when the atomic object is pushed off the RF null axis **105** in the y direction, as shown in FIGS. 2 and 7). In various embodiments, an oscillating potential **145** is configured to cause the atomic object experiencing the oscillating potential **145** to oscillate and/or experience small back and forth motions in a direction substantially parallel to RF null axis **105**/longitudinal axis **405** of the confinement apparatus **400**. For example, experiencing an oscillating potential will cause an atomic object to oscillate and/or experience small back and forth motions in a longitudinal direction of the confinement region **100** (e.g., in the x direction, as shown in FIG. 3).

(27) In various embodiments, the control signals and/or voltages applied to the longitudinal electrodes **416** are controlled by one or more connected devices (e.g., a controller **30** as shown in FIG. 9 and/or the like) via leads. For example, depending on the electric monopole and/or dipole (or higher magnitude pole) strength (e.g., electric charge in the case of an electric monopole) of the atomic object, longitudinal voltages may be raised or lowered for longitudinal electrodes **416** in the vicinity of a particular atomic object to cause the particular atomic object to traverse a desired trajectory. For example, a controller **30** may control a voltage driver to cause the voltage driver to apply control signals and/or longitudinal voltages to the longitudinal electrodes to generate a time-

dependent electric potential (e.g., an electric potential that evolves, changes, and/or varies with time) that causes the atomic objects within the confinement apparatus **400** to traverse desired trajectories. In various embodiments, the controller **30** may control a voltage driver (or other signal generator) to cause the voltage driver (or other signal generator) to generate an electric potential that causes one or more neighboring atomic objects **110B** to oscillate or experience small back and forth motions such that crosstalk is reduced during a read and/or detection function.

(28) Depending on such factors as the electric monopole and/or dipole (or higher magnitude pole) strength (e.g., electric charge in the case of an electric monopole) of the atomic objects and/or the shape and/or magnitude of the combined electrical and/or magnetic fields, the atomic objects can be stabilized at a particular distance (e.g., approximately 20 μm to approximately 200 μm) above an upper surface of the confinement apparatus **400** (e.g., the coplanar upper surface of the sequences of longitudinal electrodes **414** and RF electrodes **412**). To further contribute to controlling the transit of atomic objects along desired trajectories, the confinement apparatus **400** may be operated within a cryogenic and/or vacuum chamber capable of cooling the confinement apparatus **400** to a temperature of less than 124 Kelvin (e.g., less than 100 Kelvin, less than 50 Kelvin, less than 10 Kelvin, less than 5 Kelvin, and/or the like), in various embodiments.

(29) In various embodiments, the RF electrodes **412**, the sequences of electrodes **414**, and/or the confinement potential generated by the RF electrodes and/or the sequences of electrodes **414** define a confinement region **100** of the confinement apparatus **400**. In an example embodiment, the RF electrodes **412** and/or the confinement potential generated by the RF electrodes define a confinement region **100** of the confinement apparatus **400** and the longitudinal electrodes **416** control the movement and/or positioning of the atomic objects **110** within the confinement region **100**. In various embodiments, the RF electrodes **412**, the sequences of electrodes **414**, and/or the confinement potential generated by the RF electrodes and/or the sequences of electrodes **414** define an axis **405** of the confinement apparatus **400**. For example, the RF electrodes **412** and/or the confinement potential generated by the RF electrodes may define an axis **405** of the confinement apparatus **400**. In various embodiments, the confinement potential generally acts to align the atomic objects **110** within the confinement apparatus **400** along the RF null axis **105** and/or the longitudinal axis **405** of the confinement apparatus **400**.

Exemplary Decreased Crosstalk Reading and/or Detection Function

(30) In various embodiments, a controller **30** may control one or more drivers to cause a plurality of potential generating elements (e.g., RF electrodes **412** and longitudinal electrodes **416**) of a confinement apparatus to generate a time-dependent potential field (e.g., a potential field that evolves with time) that causes the atomic objects **110** to be confined within the confinement region **100** of the confinement apparatus **400**. An example quantum computer **910** and controller **30** are described in more detail elsewhere herein with respect to FIGS. **9** and **10**. The controller **30** may control the one or more drivers (e.g., voltage sources **50**), manipulation sources **60** (e.g., lasers), and/or the like to cause a quantum circuit to be performed using the at least two atomic objects **110** within the confinement apparatus **400**. A quantum circuit is a computational routine comprising coherent quantum operations on quantum data, such as qubits (e.g., the atomic objects **110**). For example, a quantum circuit comprises an ordered sequence of quantum gates. Execution and/or performance of a quantum circuit by a quantum computer causes the quantum computer to perform a corresponding algorithm. For example, to perform an algorithm and/or computation, a quantum computer may perform and/or execute a quantum circuit which comprises first initializing two or more qubits (e.g., the atomic objects **110**) into an initial quantum state, then performing an ordered series of quantum gates and/or other operations on the two or more qubits, and finally reading and/or detecting the quantum state of at least one of the qubits to determine an outcome and/or result of performing the algorithm and/or computation.

(31) In an example embodiment, a quantum circuit may comprise reading and/or detecting the quantum state of at least one of the qubits in the middle of the quantum of circuit. For example,

after the performance of one or more gates, the quantum state of one or more of the qubits may be read and/or detected, and then one or more further gates may be performed. In an example embodiment, the one or more further gates may be determined, modified, adjusted, selected, ordered, and/or the like based at least in part on the result of reading and/or detecting the quantum state of the at least one qubit in the middle of the quantum circuit. To enable reading and/or detecting the quantum state of at least one qubit during the performance of the quantum circuit (e.g., in the middle of the quantum circuit), the reading and/or detection function is configured so as to reduce the probability of quantum information/data stored by a qubit **110B** neighboring a qubit being read and/or detected **110A** will be disturbed, disrupted, destroyed, and/or the like during the reading and/or detecting of the qubit being read and/or detected **110A**. FIG. 5 provides a flowchart illustrating processes, procedures, operations, and/or the like performed by a controller **30**, for example, to control a quantum computer and/or cause a quantum circuit to be executed and/or performed that includes an example embodiment of a decreased crosstalk reading and/or detection function **500**. In particular, the decreased crosstalk reading and/or detection function **500** decreases and/or reduces the probability of the quantum information/data stored by a neighboring qubit **110B** being disturbed, disrupted, destroyed, and/or the like during the reading and/or detecting of the qubit being read and/or detected **110A**. For example, the decreased crosstalk reading and/or detecting function **500** may suppress the absorption of photons from a reading beam **115** and/or stimulated emission **120** by a neighboring qubit (e.g., neighboring atomic object **110B**) when another qubit (e.g., the atomic object being read and/or detected **110A**) is read and/or detected.

(32) Starting at step/operation **502**, the controller **30** causes the quantum computer **910** to begin executing and/or performing a quantum circuit. For example, the controller **30** may receive a quantum circuit and/or other executable instructions (e.g., from computing entity **10** via one or more wired and/or wireless networks) that causes the controller **30** to control one or more drivers such that voltage sources **50**, manipulation sources **60**, and/or other components of the quantum computer **910** start to perform a quantum circuit. For example, the controller **30** may cause at least two atomic objects **110** to be loaded into a confinement apparatus **400**, initialized into a particular qubit state (e.g., a known state within the defined qubit space of the atomic object **110**), and positioned in particular positions within the confinement apparatus **400**. The controller **30** may then cause one or more gates (e.g., using the one or more manipulation sources **60**) to be performed on the one or more atomic objects **110** such that the quantum state of the atomic objects **110** is evolved in a particular manner within the defined qubit space of the atomic objects **110**.

(33) As the controller **30** executes and/or performs the quantum circuit, the controller **30** may determine, at step/operation **504**, that a reading and/or detecting function is to be performed on one or more atomic objects **110** such that the quantum state of the atomic object may be determined (e.g., whether the atomic object is in qubit state 0 or 1). In an example embodiment, the controller **30** may determine that a reading and/or detecting function is to be performed in the middle of a quantum circuit (e.g., after one or more gates have been performed and one or more gates will be performed after the reading and/or detecting function). In an example embodiment, the controller **30** may determine that a reading and/or detecting function is to be performed at the end of the quantum circuit (e.g., after all of the gates of the quantum circuit have been performed). For example, the controller **30** may determine that the quantum circuit and/or the executable instructions that causes the controller **30** to control components of the quantum computer **910** to perform the quantum circuit includes an indication and/or executable instructions for performing the reading and/or detecting function. For example, the controller **30** may determine that executable instructions for performing a reading and/or detecting function are queued for execution by a processor and/or processing device of the controller **30**.

(34) The controller **30** may then execute the executable instructions for performing a decreased crosstalk reading and/or detecting function **500** via the processing device **1005** of the controller **30**.

For example, at step/operation **506**, the controller **30** may cause the voltage sources **50** to provide first control signals to one or more longitudinal electrodes **416** that causes one or more neighboring atomic objects **110B** to experience a push field **130**, as illustrated in FIG. **2**. In various embodiments, the push field **130** causes the one or more neighboring atomic objects **110B** to experience a radial force (e.g., in the y-direction) away from the RF null axis **105** and/or longitudinal axis **405** of the confinement apparatus **400**. For example, the push field **130** may cause the one or more neighboring atomic objects **110B** to be displaced a displacement distance Δy from the RF null axis **105** and/or longitudinal axis **405**. When an atomic object **110** leaves the RF null axis **105**, the atomic object **110** begins to feel the oscillations within the confinement potential generated by the RF electrodes **412** via application of an RF voltage (e.g., a voltage with an oscillation rate of an alternating electric current or voltage in the frequency range of approximately 20 kHz to 300 GHz) to the RF electrodes **412**. The oscillations within the confinement potential causes the atomic object **100** to oscillate and/or experience a small back and forth motion **135** in a radial direction (e.g., in the y-direction).

(35) The displacement distance Δy is given by

$$(36) \quad y = \frac{QE_y}{m \omega_y^2},$$

where Q is the charge of the atomic object, $E_{\text{sub.y}}$ is the electric field strength of the push field **130** in the y-direction, m is the mass of the atomic object, and $\omega_{\text{sub.y}}$ is the harmonic confinement frequency (of the confinement potential) along the y direction. The amplitude A of the oscillation and/or small back and forth motion **135** is given by

$$(37) \quad A = \sqrt{2} \frac{y}{\Omega},$$

where Ω is the oscillation frequency of the RF voltage (e.g., generated by a voltage source **50**) applied to the RF electrodes **412**. The modulation index n is then given by

$$(38) \quad n = \frac{2A}{\lambda} \cos(\phi_{\text{sub.p}}),$$

where λ is the wavelength of the reading beam **115** and/or stimulated emission **120** and $\phi_{\text{sub.p}}$ is the incident angle of the photon of the reading beam **115** (α) and/or stimulated emission **120** (θ) with respect to the atomic object **110**. For example, the reading beam **115** has an incident angle of α . In an example embodiment the incident angle of the reading beam **115** is in the range of 30-60° (e.g., α -30-60°). In various embodiments, the incident angle α provides a non-zero value for the cosine of α (e.g., α does not equal 90°). In an example embodiment, the incident angle of the stimulated emission **120** incident on a neighboring atomic object **110B** is approximately $\theta=0$.

(39) At step/operation **508**, the controller **30** causes at least one manipulation source **60** to generate and provide a reading beam **115**. For example, the reading beam **115** may be a laser beam that is tuned to a particular transition of the atomic object being read and/or detected **110A**. The reading beam **115** is provided (e.g., at incident angle α) such that at least a portion of the reading beam **115** is incident on the atomic object being read and/or detected **110A**. When the atomic object being read and/or detected **110A** is in a particular qubit state (e.g., state 1), the reading beam **115** being incident on the atomic object being read and/or detected **110A** causes the atomic object **110A** to emit stimulated emission **120**. Some of the stimulated emission **120** is detected by detector **125**. When the atomic object being read and/or detected **110A** is not in the particular qubit state (e.g., is in state 0 rather than state 1), the atomic object will not emit stimulated emission **120** responsive to the reading beam **115** being incident on the atomic object **110A**.

(40) While the reading beam **115** is provided such that at least a portion of the reading beam **115** is incident on the atomic object being read and/or detected **110A**, some of the reading beam **115** may be incident on one or more neighboring atomic objects **110B**. As the neighboring atomic object **110B** experiences the oscillation and/or small back and forth motion **135**, the neighboring atomic object **110B** sees the reading beam **115** as being off-resonant with the particular transition of the atomic object. For example, due to the Doppler effect associated with the oscillation and/or small back and forth motion **135** of the neighboring atomic object **110B**, in the reference frame of the

neighboring atomic object **110B**, the reading beam **115** is off-resonant with the particular transition of the neighboring atomic object. The modulation of the frequency of the reading beam **115** in the reference frame of a neighboring atomic object such that the sideband frequency is greater than the (e.g., a factor of two, a factor of ten, and/or the like greater than) the natural linewidth of the particular transition. Thus, absorption of photons of the reading beam **115** by the neighboring atomic object is suppressed.

(41) For example, FIG. **6A** provides a plot showing the effect on the absorption of photons from the reading beam **115** as a function of the field strength of the push field **130** (e.g., E.sub.y). In the illustrated example embodiment, when the field strength of the push field **130** is in the range of 1050-1250 V/m (e.g., 1150-1200 V/m), the modulation index is approximately 2.4 (e.g., $n \approx 2.4$) resulting, in the reference frame of the neighboring atomic object **110B**, the power of the reading beam **115** is approximately zero at the frequency/wavelength that is resonant with the particular transition of the atomic objects. Rather, in the reference frame of the neighboring atomic object **110B**, the power of the reading beam **115** is present in frequency modulation sidebands. Thus, the absorption of photons from the reading beam **115** by the neighboring atomic object **110B** experiencing oscillations and/or small back and forth motion **135** is suppressed. In other words, since the neighboring atomic object **110B** sees the power of the reading beam **115** present in the frequency modulation sidebands, which are off-resonant for quantum transitions of the atomic objects, the probability of the neighboring atomic object **110B** absorbing a photon from the reading beam **115** is greatly reduced. For example, as shown in FIG. **6A**, in the illustrated example embodiment, when the field strength of the push field **130** is in the range of 1050-1250 V/m (e.g., 1150-1200 V/m), the absorption of photons from the reading beam **115** by the neighboring atomic object **110B** is reduced to approximately 0.033. For example, FIG. **6B** provides a plot showing the suppression factor for suppressing absorption of photons from the reading beam **115** by the neighboring atomic object **110B** as a function of the field strength of the push field **130**. In the illustrated example embodiment, when the field strength of the push field **130** is in the range of 1050-1250 V/m (e.g., 1150-1200 V/m), the suppression factor reaches a first maximum of approximately 30.

(42) Returning to FIG. **5**, at step/operation **510**, the controller **30** may cause the voltage sources **50** to provide second control signals to one or more longitudinal electrodes **416** that causes one or more neighboring atomic objects **110B** to experience an oscillating potential **145**, as illustrated in FIG. **3**. In various embodiments, the oscillating potential causes the one or more neighboring atomic objects **110B** to experience an oscillating longitudinal force (e.g., in the x-direction and/or substantially parallel to the RF null axis **105** and/or longitudinal axis **405** of the confinement apparatus **400**). When the neighboring atomic object **110B** feels the oscillations of the oscillating potential **145**, the neighboring atomic object **110B** begins to oscillate and/or experience a small back and forth motion **140** in the longitudinal direction (e.g., in the x-direction). In general, the oscillating potential **145** is configured to cause the neighboring atomic object **110B** begin to oscillate and/or experience small back and forth motion **140** in a direction that is substantially parallel to and/or comprises a component that is substantially parallel to the direction between the neighboring atomic object **110B** and the atomic object being read and/or detected **110A**.

(43) Due to the oscillation and/or small back and forth motion **140**, at least a component of which is substantially parallel to the direction stimulated emission **120** would travel from the atomic object being read **110A** to the neighboring atomic object **110B**, the stimulated emission **120** will be off-resonant for quantum transitions of the atomic objects in the reference frame of the neighboring atomic object **110B**. Thus, absorption of the stimulated emission **120** by the neighboring atomic object **110B** is suppressed and/or decreased. The longitudinal electrodes **416** may be controlled such that after a period of time (e.g., a time period in which its expected at least most of the stimulated emission **120** has been emitted) the longitudinal electrodes **416** cease generating the oscillating potential **145**. In an example embodiment, the strength of the oscillating potential **145**

may be decreased in an at least semi-smooth manner rather than being abruptly turned off.

(44) In an example embodiment, the control signals provided to the longitudinal electrodes **416** is filtered to reduce high frequency noise. In an example embodiment, the filters used to filter the control signals provided to the longitudinal electrodes **416** are configured to allow and/or pass signals of a particular frequency such that the longitudinal electrodes **416** may generate the oscillating potential.

(45) At step/operation **512**, the controller **30** controls the magnetic field generator **70** to generate a magnetic field **170** experienced by the neighboring atomic object **110B** as having a magnetic field direction and a particular amplitude. In an example embodiment, the magnetic field generator **70** is a permanent magnet and the controller **30** need not control the magnetic field generator **70**. In an example embodiment, the magnetic field generator **70** is configured to generate and/or maintain a substantially stable magnetic field having a magnetic field direction and a particular amplitude throughout the operation of the quantum computer **910** and/or the performance of a quantum circuit and/or algorithm. Thus, the controller **30** controls the magnetic field generator **70** to maintain the magnetic field **170** such that the neighboring atomic object **110B** experiences the magnetic field **170** having the magnetic field direction and the particular amplitude, in an example embodiment. In various embodiments, the magnetic field direction experienced by the neighboring atomic object **110B** is transverse (e.g., not parallel or anti-parallel) to the gradient of the oscillating potential **145** and/or transverse to an axis defined by the small back and forth motion **135**. For example, as illustrated in FIG. 2, in an example embodiment, the magnetic field direction experienced by the neighboring atomic object **110B** is perpendicular to the gradient of the oscillating potential **145** and/or perpendicular to the axis defined by the small back and forth motion **135**. In an example embodiment, the magnetic field direction is generally and/or substantially parallel to the direction separating the neighboring atomic object **110B** and the atomic object being read and/or detected **110A**.

(46) Due to the zero in the lobed emission pattern of π -polarized light by an atomic object and the magnetic field direction being generally and/or substantially parallel to the direction separating the neighboring atomic object **110B** and the atomic object being read and/or detected **110A**, any stimulated emission **120** (e.g., photons) emitted by the atomic object being read and/or detected **110A** in the direction of the neighboring atomic object **110B** will not have a π -polarized component (e.g., the π -polarized component will be substantially equal to zero). As the probability of the neighboring atomic object **110B** resonantly absorbing non- π -polarized light is very small (e.g., substantially and/or approximately equal to zero), the absorption of stimulated emission **120** photons by the neighboring atomic object **110B** is significantly suppressed and/or reduced. For example, absorption of photons by the neighboring atomic object **110B** is suppressed in the direction of the gradient of the oscillating potential **145** and/or the axis defined by the small back and forth motion **135** and suppressed in the magnetic field direction of the magnetic field **170**, in an example embodiment.

(47) In various embodiments, steps/operations **506**, **508**, **510**, and/or **512** may be performed in a semi-simultaneous and/or overlapping manner. For example, the field strength of the radial push field may have a triangle wave pulse form over time, such that the field strength of the radial push field increases to a maximum and then decreases again. For example, the time evolution of the field strength of the push field **130** may comprise a monotonic increase to a maximum followed by a monotonic decrease to a minimum. When the field strength of the push field **130** is approximately at its maximum and/or slightly past its maximum, the reading beam **115** may be provided and/or applied. The field strength of the push field **130** may then decrease to a minimum, causing the neighboring atomic object **110B** to return to the RF null axis **105** and cease oscillating and/or experiencing the small back and forth motion **135** in the radial direction. In an example embodiment, the controller **30** may cause the longitudinal electrodes **416** to generate the oscillating potential **145** prior to the application of the reading beam **115** to the atomic object being read

and/or detected **110A** such that the neighboring atomic object **110B** is experiencing the oscillations and/or small back and forth motion **140** when the stimulated emission **120** is emitted by the atomic object being read and/or detected **110A**.

(48) In an example embodiment, one or more cooling operations may be performed to cool the neighboring atomic objects **110B**. For example, cooling the neighboring atomic objects **110B** may be performed via direct cooling techniques, sympathetic cooling (e.g., via a sympathetic cooling atomic object), and/or the like. In an example embodiment, the cooling operation may dampen and/or suppress any residual oscillations and/or small back and forth movement of the neighboring atomic objects **110B**.

(49) At step/operation **514**, the controller **30** may receive a read result. For example, the controller **30** may receive a signal from the detector **125** indicating whether the atomic object being read and/or detected was in a particular qubit state. For example, the signal from the detector **125** may indicate whether the atomic object being read and/or detected **110A** was in the first state. The controller **30** may then adjust, modify, update, and/or the like the remaining portion of the quantum circuit based on whether the atomic object being read and/or detected **110A** was in the first state. In an example embodiment, multiple atomic objects may be read and the controller **30** may adjust, modify, update, and/or the like the remaining portion of the quantum circuit based on the result of reading the multiple atomic objects. For example, the controller **30** may make changes to the remaining portion of the quantum circuit based on and/or responsive to the result of reading and/or detecting one or more atomic objects during the course of performing and/or executing the quantum circuit.

(50) At step/operation **516**, the controller **30** controls various components of the quantum computer **910** to continue performing and/or executing the quantum circuit. For example, the controller may cause the quantum computer **910** to continue performing and/or executing the possibly modified, adjusted, updated, and/or the like quantum circuit. For example, the quantum computer **910** may continue performing and/or executing the quantum circuit, including performing one or more gates, moving atomic objects within the confinement apparatus **400**, performing additional reading and/or detecting functions (such as decreased crosstalk reading and/or detecting functions), and/or the like. The controller **30** may then communicate one or more results of performing and/or executing the quantum circuit to a computing entity **10** via one or more wired and/or wireless networks **20**.

Another Exemplary Decreased Crosstalk Reading and/or Detection Function

(51) FIG. 7 provides a schematic diagram of another exemplary decreased crosstalk reading and/or detection function **800**, as described in FIG. 8. In particular, a push field **130** is applied to the atomic object being read and/or detected **110A** that causes the atomic object being read and/or detected **110A** to move radially away from the RF null axis **105** and experience oscillations and/or small back and forth motions in a radial direction (e.g., in the y-direction). The frequency/wavelength of the reading beam **115'** may then be modulated such that, in the reference frame of the atomic object being read and/or detected **110A**, the reading beam **115'** is on resonant for a particular transition of the atomic object. However, in the respective reference frames of the neighboring atomic objects **110B**, the modulated reading beam **115'** will be off-resonant for quantum transitions of the neighboring atomic objects.

(52) FIG. 8 provides a flowchart illustrating various processes, procedures, operations, and/or the like of operating a quantum computer to perform a quantum circuit comprising a decreased crosstalk reading and/or detection function **800**, in accordance with an example embodiment. Starting at step/operation **802**, the controller **30** causes the quantum computer **910** to begin executing and/or performing a quantum circuit. For example, the controller **30** may receive a quantum circuit and/or other executable instructions (e.g., from computing entity **10** via one or more wired and/or wireless networks) that causes the controller **30** to control one or more drivers such that voltage sources **50**, manipulation sources **60**, and/or other components of the quantum computer **910** start to perform a quantum circuit. For example, the controller **30** may cause at least

two atomic objects **110** to be loaded into a confinement apparatus **400**, initialized into a particular qubit state (e.g., a known state within the defined qubit space of the atomic object **110**), and positioned in particular positions within the confinement apparatus **400**. The controller **30** may then cause one or more gates (e.g., using the one or more manipulation sources **60**) to be performed on the one or more atomic objects **110** such that the quantum state of the atomic objects **110** is evolved in a particular manner within the defined qubit space of the atomic objects **110**.

(53) As the controller **30** executes and/or performs the quantum circuit, the controller **30** may determine, at step/operation **804**, that a reading and/or detecting function is to be performed on one or more atomic objects **110** such that the quantum state of the atomic object may be determined (e.g., whether the atomic object is in qubit state 0 or 1). In an example embodiment, the controller **30** may determine that a reading and/or detecting function is to be performed in the middle of a quantum circuit (e.g., after one or more gates have been performed and one or more gates will be performed after the reading and/or detecting function). In an example embodiment, the controller **30** may determine that a reading and/or detecting function is to be performed at the end of the quantum circuit (e.g., after all of the gates of the quantum circuit have been performed). For example, the controller **30** may determine that the quantum circuit and/or the executable instructions that causes the controller **30** to control components of the quantum computer **910** to perform the quantum circuit includes an indication and/or executable instructions for performing the reading and/or detecting function. For example, the controller **30** may determine that executable instructions for performing a reading and/or detecting function are queued for execution by a processor and/or processing device of the controller **30**.

(54) The controller **30** may then execute the executable instructions for performing a decreased crosstalk reading and/or detecting function **800** via the processing device **1005** of the controller **30**. For example, at step/operation **806**, the controller **30** may cause the voltage sources **50** to provide first control signals to one or more longitudinal electrodes **416** that causes the atomic object to be read and/or detected **110A** to experience a push field **130**, as illustrated in FIG. 7. In various embodiments, the push field **130** causes the atomic object being read and/or detected **110A** to experience a radial force (e.g., in the y-direction) away from the RF null axis **105** and/or longitudinal axis **405** of the confinement apparatus **400**. For example, the push field **130** may cause the atomic object being read and/or detected **110A** to be displaced a displacement distance Δy from the RF null axis **105** and/or longitudinal axis **405**. When the atomic object being read and/or detected **110A** leaves the RF null axis **105**, the atomic object **110A** begins to feel the oscillations within the confinement potential generated by the RF electrodes **412** via application of an RF voltage (e.g., a voltage with an oscillation rate of an alternating electric current or voltage in the frequency range of approximately 20 kHz to 300 GHz) to the RF electrodes **412**. The oscillations within the confinement potential causes the atomic object **100** to oscillate and/or experience a small back and forth motion **135** in a radial direction (e.g., in the y-direction).

(55) Similar to as described above, the displacement distance Δy is given by

$$(56) \quad y = \frac{QE_y}{m \omega_y^2},$$

where Q is the charge of the atomic object, $E_{\text{sub.y}}$ is the electric field strength of the push field **130** in the y-direction, m is the mass of the atomic object, and $\omega_{\text{sub.y}}$ is the harmonic confinement frequency (of the confinement potential) along the y direction. The amplitude A of the oscillation and/or small back and forth motion **135** is given by

$$(57) \quad A = \sqrt{2} \frac{y}{\Omega},$$

where Ω is the oscillation frequency of the RF voltage (e.g., generated by a voltage source **50**) applied to the RF electrodes **412**. The modulation index n is then given by

$$(58) \quad n = \frac{2A}{\lambda} \cos(\phi_p),$$

where λ is the wavelength of the modulated reading beam **115'** and $\phi_{\text{sub.p}}$ is the incident angle of the photon of the modulated reading beam **115'** with respect to the atomic object being read and/or

detected **110A**. For example, the modulated reading beam **115'** has an incident angle of α . In an example embodiment the incident angle of the modulated reading beam **115'** is in the range of 30-60° (e.g., $\alpha=30-60^\circ$).

(59) At step/operation **808**, the controller **30** causes at least one manipulation source **60** to generate and provide a modulated reading beam **115'**. For example, the modulated reading beam **115'** may be a laser beam that is tuned and modulated to a particular transition of the atomic object being read and/or detected **110A** in the reference frame of the atomic object being read and/or detected **110A** which is oscillating and/or experiencing small back and forth motions **135**. For example, the frequency/wavelength of the reading beam may be modulated such that the when the modulated reading beam **115'** is incident on the atomic object being read and/or detected **110A**, the frequency/wavelength of the reading beam is on-resonant with the particular transition of the atomic object **110A**. The modulated reading beam **115'** is provided (e.g., at incident angle α) such that at least a portion of the modulated reading beam **115'** is incident on the atomic object being read and/or detected **110A**. When the atomic object being read and/or detected **110A** is in a particular qubit state (e.g., state 1), the modulated reading beam **115'** being incident on the atomic object being read and/or detected **110A** causes the atomic object **110A** to emit stimulated emission **120**. Some of the stimulated emission **120** is detected by detector **125**. When the atomic object being read and/or detected **110A** is not in the particular qubit state (e.g., is in state 0 rather than state 1), the atomic object will not emit stimulated emission **120** responsive to the modulated reading beam **115'** being incident on the atomic object **110A**.

(60) While the modulated reading beam **115'** is provided such that at least a portion of the modulated reading beam **115'** is incident on the atomic object being read and/or detected **110A**, some of the modulated reading beam **115'** may be incident on one or more neighboring atomic objects **110B**. However, as the modulated reading beam **115'** is modulated to be on resonance for in the reference frame of the atomic object being read and/or detected, which is moving with respect to the respective reference frames of the neighboring atomic objects **110B**, the modulated reading beam **115'** is off resonance for the quantum transitions of the neighboring atomic objects **110B**. Thus, absorption of photons of the modulated reading beam **115'** by the neighboring atomic objects **110B** is suppressed.

(61) At step/operation **810**, the controller **30** may cause the voltage sources **50** to provide second control signals to one or more longitudinal electrodes **416** that causes the atomic object being read and/or detected **110A** to experience an oscillating potential **145**, similar to as illustrated in FIG. 3. In various embodiments, the oscillating potential causes the atomic object being read and/or detected **110A** to experience an oscillating longitudinal force (e.g., in the x-direction and/or substantially parallel to the RF null axis **105** and/or longitudinal axis **405** of the confinement apparatus **400**). When the atomic object being read **110A** feels the oscillations of the oscillating potential **145**, the atomic object **110A** begins to oscillate and/or experience a small back and forth motion **140** in the longitudinal direction (e.g., in the x-direction). In general, the oscillating potential **145** is configured to cause the atomic object being read and/or detected **110A** begin to oscillate and/or experience small back and forth motion **140** in a direction that is substantially parallel to and/or comprises a component that is substantially parallel to the direction between a neighboring atomic object **110B** and the atomic object being read and/or detected **110A**.

(62) Due to the oscillation and/or small back and forth motion **140**, at least a component of which is substantially parallel to the direction stimulated emission **120** would travel from the atomic object being read **110A** to the neighboring atomic object **110B**, the stimulated emission **120** will be off-resonant for quantum transitions of the atomic objects in the reference frame of the neighboring atomic object **110B**. Thus, absorption of the stimulated emission **120** by the neighboring atomic object **110B** is suppressed and/or decreased. The longitudinal electrodes **416** may be controlled such that after a period of time (e.g., a time period in which its expected at least most of the stimulated emission **120** has been emitted) the longitudinal electrodes **416** cease generating the

oscillating potential **145**. In an example embodiment, the strength of the oscillating potential **145** may be decreased in an at least semi-smooth manner rather than being abruptly turned off.

(63) In various embodiments, steps/operations **806**, **808**, and/or **810** may be performed in a semi-simultaneous and/or overlapping manner. For example, the field strength of the radial push field may have a triangle wave pulse form over time, such that the field strength of the radial push field increases to a maximum and then decreases again. For example, the time evolution of the field strength of the push field **130** may comprise a monotonic increase to a maximum followed by a monotonic decrease to a minimum. When the field strength of the push field **130** is approximately at its maximum and/or slightly past its maximum, the modulated reading beam **115'** may be provided and/or applied. The field strength of the push field **130** may then decrease to a minimum, causing the atomic object being read and/or detected **110A** to return to the RF null axis **105** and cease oscillating and/or experiencing the small back and forth motion **135** in the radial direction. In an example embodiment, the controller **30** may cause the longitudinal electrodes **416** to generate the oscillating potential **145** prior to the application of the modulated reading beam **115'** to the atomic object being read and/or detected **110A** such that the atomic object being read and/or detected **110A** is experiencing the oscillations and/or small back and forth motion **140** when the stimulated emission **120** is emitted by the atomic object being read and/or detected **110A**.

(64) In an example embodiment, one or more cooling operations may be performed to cool the atomic object being read and/or detected **110A**. For example, cooling the atomic object being read and/or detected **110A** may be performed via direct cooling techniques, sympathetic cooling (e.g., via a sympathetic cooling atomic object), and/or the like. In an example embodiment, the cooling operation may dampen and/or suppress any residual oscillations and/or small back and forth movement of the atomic object being read and/or detected **110A**.

(65) In an example embodiment, the controller **30** may control various components of the quantum computer **910** such that the longitudinal electrodes **416** to generate a push field **130** that is experienced by the atomic object being read and/or detected **110A** and an oscillating potential **145** that is experienced by one or more neighboring atomic objects **110B**, or vice versa. In various embodiments, the controller **30** may control various components of the quantum computer **910** such that the longitudinal electrodes **416** generate a push field **130** that is experienced by the atomic object being read and/or detected **110A** (or neighboring atomic objects **110B**) and does not generate an oscillating potential.

(66) At step/operation **812**, the controller may receive a read result. For example, the controller **30** may receive a signal from the detector **125** indicating whether the atomic object being read and/or detected was in a particular qubit state. For example, the signal from the detector **125** may indicate whether the atomic object being read and/or detected **110A** was in the first state. The controller **30** may then adjust, modify, update, and/or the like the remaining portion of the quantum circuit based on whether the atomic object being read and/or detected **110A** was in the first state. In an example embodiment, multiple atomic objects may be read and the controller **30** may adjust, modify, update, and/or the like the remaining portion of the quantum circuit based on the result of reading the multiple atomic objects. For example, the controller **30** may make changes to the remaining portion of the quantum circuit based on and/or responsive to the result of reading and/or detecting one or more atomic objects during the course of performing and/or executing the quantum circuit.

(67) At step/operation **814**, the controller **30** controls various components of the quantum computer **910** to continue performing and/or executing the quantum circuit. For example, the controller may cause the quantum computer **910** to continue performing and/or executing the possibly modified, adjusted, updated, and/or the like quantum circuit. For example, the quantum computer **910** may continue performing and/or executing the quantum circuit, including performing one or more gates, moving atomic objects within the confinement apparatus **400**, performing additional reading and/or detecting functions (such as decreased crosstalk reading and/or detecting functions), and/or the like. The controller **30** may then communicate one or more results of performing and/or executing the

quantum circuit to a computing entity **10** via one or more wired and/or wireless networks **20**.

Technical Advantages

(68) Various embodiments provide technical solutions to the technical problem of reading and/or detecting an atomic object within a confinement apparatus without disturbing quantum information/data stored and/or encoded by the quantum state of neighboring atomic objects within the confinement apparatus. For example, crosstalk during a reading and/or detecting function may decohere a neighboring atomic object. Various embodiments provide decreased crosstalk reading and/or detection functions that preserve the quantum information/data stored by neighboring atomic objects during the reading and/or detection function. Various embodiments enable reading and/or detecting functions to be performed during the middle of the performance and/or execution of a quantum circuit (e.g., by a quantum computer) without disrupting the quantum information/data stored by the neighboring atomic objects during the performance of the reading and/or detection function.

(69) Thus, various embodiments provide technical improvements to the fields of quantum computer operation (e.g., for a trapped ion quantum computer and/or the like) and to the field of reading and/or detecting atomic objects within an atomic object confinement apparatus in applications that are sensitive to crosstalk.

Exemplary Quantum Computer Comprising an Ion Trap Apparatus

(70) As described above, a decreased crosstalk reading and/or detecting function is performed by a controller **30** of a quantum computer **910**, in various embodiments. FIG. **9** provides a schematic diagram of an example quantum computer system **900** comprising a confinement apparatus **400** (e.g., an ion trap), in accordance with an example embodiment.

(71) In various embodiments, the quantum computer system **900** comprises a computing entity **10** and a quantum computer **910**. In various embodiments, the quantum computer **910** comprises a controller **30**, a cryostat and/or vacuum chamber **40** enclosing a confinement apparatus **400**, one or more manipulation sources **60**, one or more voltage sources **50**, one or more magnetic field generators **70** (e.g., **70A**, **70B**), an optics collection system **80**, and/or the like. In various embodiments, the controller **30** is configured to control the operation of (e.g., control one or more drivers configured to cause operation of) the manipulation sources **60**, voltage sources **50**, magnetic field generators **70**, a vacuum system and/or cryogenic cooling system (not shown), and/or the like. In various embodiments, the controller **30** is configured to receive signals (e.g., electrical signals) generated and provided by the optics collection system **80**.

(72) In an example embodiment, the one or more manipulation sources **60** may comprise one or more lasers (e.g., optical lasers, microwave sources, and/or the like). In various embodiments, the one or more manipulation sources **60** are configured to manipulate and/or cause a controlled quantum state evolution of one or more atomic objects **110** within the confinement apparatus **400**. In an example embodiment, at least one of the one or more manipulation sources **60** is configured to generate and provide a reading beam **115**. For example, in an example embodiment, wherein the one or more manipulation sources **60** comprise one or more lasers, the lasers may provide one or more laser beams to the confinement apparatus within the cryogenic and/or vacuum chamber **40** via beam paths **66** (e.g., **66A**, **66B**, **66C**).

(73) In various embodiments, the quantum computer **910** comprises one or more voltage sources **50**. For example, the voltage sources may be arbitrary wave generators (AWG), and/or other voltage signal generators. For example, the voltage sources **50** may comprise a plurality of longitudinal voltage drivers and/or voltage sources and/or at least one RF driver and/or voltage source. The voltage sources **50** may be electrically coupled to the corresponding potential generating elements (e.g., longitudinal electrodes **416** and/or RF electrodes **412**) of the confinement apparatus **400**, in an example embodiment.

(74) In various embodiments, the quantum computer **910** comprises one or more magnetic field generators **70** (e.g., **70A**, **70B**). For example, the magnetic field generator may be an internal

magnetic field generator **70A** disposed within the cryogenic and/or vacuum chamber **40** and/or an external magnetic field generator **70B** disposed outside of the cryogenic and/or vacuum chamber **40**. In various embodiments, the magnetic field generators **70** comprise permanent magnets, Helmholtz coils, electrical magnets, and/or the like. In various embodiments, the magnetic field generators **70** are configured to generate a magnetic field at one or more regions of the atomic object confinement apparatus **400** that has a particular magnitude and a particular magnetic field direction in the one or more regions of the atomic object confinement apparatus **400**.

(75) In various embodiments, the quantum computer **910** comprises an optics collection system **80** configured to collect and/or detect photons (e.g., stimulated emission **120**) generated by qubits (e.g., during reading procedures). The optics collection system **80** may comprise one or more optical elements (e.g., lenses, mirrors, waveguides, fiber optics cables, and/or the like) and one or more photodetectors. In various embodiments, the photodetectors may be photodiodes, photomultipliers, charge-coupled device (CCD) sensors, complementary metal oxide semiconductor (CMOS) sensors, Micro-Electro-Mechanical Systems (MEMS) sensors, and/or other photodetectors that are sensitive to light at an expected fluorescence wavelength of the qubits (e.g., atomic objects) of the quantum computer **910**. In various embodiments, the detectors may be in electronic communication with the quantum system controller **30** via one or more A/D converters **1025** (see FIG. **10**) and/or the like.

(76) In various embodiments, a computing entity **10** is configured to allow a user to provide input to the quantum computer **910** (e.g., via a user interface of the computing entity **10**) and receive, view, and/or the like output from the quantum computer **910**. The computing entity **10** may be in communication with the controller **30** of the quantum computer **910** via one or more wired or wireless networks **20** and/or via direct wired and/or wireless communications. In an example embodiment, the computing entity **10** may translate, configure, format, and/or the like information/data, quantum computing algorithms (e.g., quantum circuits), and/or the like into a computing language, executable instructions, command sets, and/or the like that the controller **30** can understand, execute, and/or implement.

(77) In various embodiments, the controller **30** is configured to control the voltage sources **50**, magnetic field generators **70**, cryogenic system and/or vacuum system controlling the temperature and pressure within the cryogenic and/or vacuum chamber **40**, manipulation sources **60**, and/or other systems controlling various environmental conditions (e.g., temperature, pressure, and/or the like) within the cryogenic and/or vacuum chamber **40**, configured to manipulate and/or cause a controlled evolution of quantum states of one or more atomic objects within the confinement apparatus, and/or read and/or detect a quantum (e.g., qubit) state of one or more atomic objects within the confinement apparatus. For example, the controller **30** may cause a controlled evolution of quantum states of one or more atomic objects within the confinement apparatus to execute a quantum circuit and/or algorithm. For example, the controller **30** may read and/or detect quantum states of one or more atomic objects within the confinement apparatus at one or more points during the execution of a quantum circuit. In various embodiments, the atomic objects confined within the confinement apparatus are used as qubits of the quantum computer **910**.

Exemplary Controller

(78) In various embodiments, a confinement apparatus **400** is incorporated into a quantum computer **910**. In various embodiments, a quantum computer **910** further comprises a controller **30** configured to control various elements of the quantum computer **910**. For example, the controller **30** may be configured to control the voltage sources **50**, a cryogenic system and/or vacuum system controlling the temperature and pressure within the cryogenic and/or vacuum chamber **40**, manipulation sources **60**, magnetic field generators **70**, and/or other systems controlling the environmental conditions (e.g., temperature, humidity, pressure, and/or the like) within the cryogenic and/or vacuum chamber **40**, configured to manipulate and/or cause a controlled evolution of quantum states of one or more atomic objects within the confinement apparatus,

and/or read and/or detect a quantum state of one or more atomic objects within the confinement apparatus.

(79) As shown in FIG. 10, in various embodiments, the controller **30** may comprise various controller elements including processing elements **1005**, memory **1010**, driver controller elements **1015**, a communication interface **1020**, analog-digital converter elements **1025**, and/or the like. For example, the processing elements **1005** may comprise programmable logic devices (CPLDs), microprocessors, coprocessing entities, application-specific instruction-set processors (ASIPs), integrated circuits, application specific integrated circuits (ASICs), field programmable gate arrays (FPGAs), programmable logic arrays (PLAs), hardware accelerators, other processing devices and/or circuitry, and/or the like. and/or controllers. The term circuitry may refer to an entirely hardware embodiment or a combination of hardware and computer program products. In an example embodiment, the processing element **1005** of the controller **30** comprises a clock and/or is in communication with a clock.

(80) For example, the memory **1010** may comprise non-transitory memory such as volatile and/or non-volatile memory storage such as one or more of as hard disks, ROM, PROM, EPROM, EEPROM, flash memory, MMCs, SD memory cards, Memory Sticks, CBRAM, PRAM, FeRAM, RRAM, SONOS, racetrack memory, RAM, DRAM, SRAM, FPM DRAM, EDO DRAM, SDRAM, DDR SDRAM, DDR2 SDRAM, DDR3 SDRAM, RDRAM, RIMM, DIMM, SIMM, VRAM, cache memory, register memory, and/or the like. In various embodiments, the memory **1010** may store qubit records corresponding the qubits of quantum computer (e.g., in a qubit record data store, qubit record database, qubit record table, and/or the like), a calibration table, an executable queue, computer program code (e.g., in a one or more computer languages, specialized controller language(s), and/or the like), and/or the like. In an example embodiment, execution of at least a portion of the computer program code stored in the memory **1010** (e.g., by a processing element **1005**) causes the controller **30** to perform one or more steps, operations, processes, procedures and/or the like described herein for controlling one or more components of the quantum computer **910** (e.g., voltages sources **50**, manipulation sources **60**, magnetic field generators **70**, and/or the like) to cause a controlled evolution of quantum states of one or more atomic objects, detect and/or read the quantum state of one or more atomic objects, and/or the like.

(81) In various embodiments, the driver controller elements **1015** may include one or more drivers and/or controller elements each configured to control one or more drivers. In various embodiments, the driver controller elements **1015** may comprise drivers and/or driver controllers. For example, the driver controllers may be configured to cause one or more corresponding drivers to be operated in accordance with executable instructions, commands, and/or the like scheduled and executed by the controller **30** (e.g., by the processing element **1005**). In various embodiments, the driver controller elements **1015** may enable the controller **30** to operate a manipulation source **60**. In various embodiments, the drivers may be laser drivers; vacuum component drivers; drivers for controlling the flow of current and/or voltage applied to longitudinal, RF, and/or other electrodes used for maintaining and/or controlling the confinement potential of the confinement apparatus (and/or other driver for providing driver action sequences and/or control signals to potential generating elements of the confinement apparatus); cryogenic and/or vacuum system component drivers; and/or the like. For example, the drivers may control and/or comprise longitudinal and/or RF voltage drivers and/or voltage sources that provide voltages and/or electrical signals to the longitudinal electrodes **416** and/or RF electrodes **412**. In various embodiments, the controller **30** comprises means for communicating and/or receiving signals from one or more detectors **125** such as optical receiver components (e.g., cameras, MEMs cameras, CCD cameras, photodiodes, photomultiplier tubes, and/or the like). For example, the controller **30** may comprise one or more analog-digital converter elements **1025** configured to receive signals from one or more detectors **125**, optical receiver components, calibration sensors, and/or the like.

(82) In various embodiments, the controller **30** may comprise a communication interface **1020** for

interfacing and/or communicating with a computing entity **10**. For example, the controller **30** may comprise a communication interface **1020** for receiving executable instructions, command sets, and/or the like from the computing entity **10** and providing output received from the quantum computer **910** (e.g., from an optical collection system comprising one or more detectors **125**) and/or the result of a processing the output to the computing entity **10**. In various embodiments, the computing entity **10** and the controller **30** may communicate via a direct wired and/or wireless connection and/or one or more wired and/or wireless networks **20**.

Exemplary Computing Entity

(83) FIG. **11** provides an illustrative schematic representative of an example computing entity **10** that can be used in conjunction with embodiments of the present invention. In various embodiments, a computing entity **10** is configured to allow a user to provide input to the quantum computer **910** (e.g., via a user interface of the computing entity **10**) and receive, display, analyze, and/or the like output from the quantum computer **910**.

(84) As shown in FIG. **11**, a computing entity **10** can include an antenna **1112**, a transmitter **1104** (e.g., radio), a receiver **1106** (e.g., radio), and a processing element **1108** that provides signals to and receives signals from the transmitter **1104** and receiver **1106**, respectively. The signals provided to and received from the transmitter **1104** and the receiver **1106**, respectively, may include signaling information/data in accordance with an air interface standard of applicable wireless systems to communicate with various entities, such as a controller **30**, other computing entities **10**, and/or the like. In this regard, the computing entity **10** may be capable of operating with one or more air interface standards, communication protocols, modulation types, and access types. For example, the computing entity **10** may be configured to receive and/or provide communications using a wired data transmission protocol, such as fiber distributed data interface (FDDI), digital subscriber line (DSL), Ethernet, asynchronous transfer mode (ATM), frame relay, data over cable service interface specification (DOCSIS), or any other wired transmission protocol. Similarly, the computing entity **10** may be configured to communicate via wireless external communication networks using any of a variety of protocols, such as general packet radio service (GPRS), Universal Mobile Telecommunications System (UMTS), Code Division Multiple Access 2000 (CDMA2000), CDMA2000 1× (1×RTT), Wideband Code Division Multiple Access (WCDMA), Global System for Mobile Communications (GSM), Enhanced Data rates for GSM Evolution (EDGE), Time Division-Synchronous Code Division Multiple Access (TD-SCDMA), Long Term Evolution (LTE), Evolved Universal Terrestrial Radio Access Network (E-UTRAN), Evolution-Data Optimized (EVDO), High Speed Packet Access (HSPA), High-Speed Downlink Packet Access (HSDPA), IEEE 802.11 (Wi-Fi), Wi-Fi Direct, 802.16 (WiMAX), ultra-wideband (UWB), infrared (IR) protocols, near field communication (NFC) protocols, Wibree, Bluetooth protocols, wireless universal serial bus (USB) protocols, and/or any other wireless protocol. The computing entity **10** may use such protocols and standards to communicate using Border Gateway Protocol (BGP), Dynamic Host Configuration Protocol (DHCP), Domain Name System (DNS), File Transfer Protocol (FTP), Hypertext Transfer Protocol (HTTP), HTTP over TLS/SSL/Secure, Internet Message Access Protocol (IMAP), Network Time Protocol (NTP), Simple Mail Transfer Protocol (SMTP), Telnet, Transport Layer Security (TLS), Secure Sockets Layer (SSL), Internet Protocol (IP), Transmission Control Protocol (TCP), User Datagram Protocol (UDP), Datagram Congestion Control Protocol (DCCP), Stream Control Transmission Protocol (SCTP), HyperText Markup Language (HTML), and/or the like.

(85) Via these communication standards and protocols, the computing entity **10** can communicate with various other entities using concepts such as Unstructured Supplementary Service information/data (USSD), Short Message Service (SMS), Multimedia Messaging Service (MMS), Dual-Tone Multi-Frequency Signaling (DTMF), and/or Subscriber Identity Module Dialer (SIM dialer). The computing entity **10** can also download changes, add-ons, and updates, for instance, to its firmware, software (e.g., including executable instructions, applications, program modules), and

operating system.

(86) The computing entity **10** may also comprise a user interface device comprising one or more user input/output interfaces (e.g., a display **1116** and/or speaker/speaker driver coupled to a processing element **1108** and a touch screen, keyboard, mouse, and/or microphone coupled to a processing element **1108**). For instance, the user output interface may be configured to provide an application, browser, user interface, interface, dashboard, screen, webpage, page, and/or similar words used herein interchangeably executing on and/or accessible via the computing entity **10** to cause display or audible presentation of information/data and for interaction therewith via one or more user input interfaces. The user input interface can comprise any of a number of devices allowing the computing entity **10** to receive data, such as a keypad **1118** (hard or soft), a touch display, voice/speech or motion interfaces, scanners, readers, or other input device. In embodiments including a keypad **1118**, the keypad **1118** can include (or cause display of) the conventional numeric (0-9) and related keys (#, *), and other keys used for operating the computing entity **10** and may include a full set of alphabetic keys or set of keys that may be activated to provide a full set of alphanumeric keys. In addition to providing input, the user input interface can be used, for example, to activate or deactivate certain functions, such as screen savers and/or sleep modes. Through such inputs the computing entity **10** can collect information/data, user interaction/input, and/or the like.

(87) The computing entity **10** can also include volatile storage or memory **1122** and/or non-volatile storage or memory **1124**, which can be embedded and/or may be removable. For instance, the non-volatile memory may be ROM, PROM, EPROM, EEPROM, flash memory, MMCs, SD memory cards, Memory Sticks, CBRAM, PRAM, FeRAM, RRAM, SONOS, racetrack memory, and/or the like. The volatile memory may be RAM, DRAM, SRAM, FPM DRAM, EDO DRAM, SDRAM, DDR SDRAM, DDR2 SDRAM, DDR3 SDRAM, RDRAM, RIMM, DIMM, SIMM, VRAM, cache memory, register memory, and/or the like. The volatile and non-volatile storage or memory can store databases, database instances, database management system entities, data, applications, programs, program modules, scripts, source code, object code, byte code, compiled code, interpreted code, machine code, executable instructions, and/or the like to implement the functions of the computing entity **10**.

Conclusion

(88) Many modifications and other embodiments of the invention set forth herein will come to mind to one skilled in the art to which the invention pertains having the benefit of the teachings presented in the foregoing descriptions and the associated drawings. Therefore, it is to be understood that the invention is not to be limited to the specific embodiments disclosed and that modifications and other embodiments are intended to be included within the scope of the appended claims. Although specific terms are employed herein, they are used in a generic and descriptive sense only and not for purposes of limitation.

Claims

1. A method comprising: providing at least two atomic objects within a confinement apparatus, the at least two atomic objects comprising an atomic object being read and at least one neighboring atomic object; controlling operation of the confinement apparatus to cause one of the atomic object being read or the at least one neighboring atomic object to oscillate in a first direction; and causing a manipulation source to generate and provide a reading beam in a reading beam direction such that the reading beam is incident at least in part on the atomic object being read.
2. The method of claim 1, wherein the first direction has a non-zero component in the reading beam direction.
3. The method of claim 1, wherein the reading beam is resonant with a particular quantum transition of the atomic object being read.

4. The method of claim 1, wherein the atomic object being read oscillates in the first direction and a frequency of the reading beam is modulated so that in an oscillating reference frame of the atomic object being read, the reading beam is resonant with a particular quantum transition of the atomic object being read.
5. The method of claim 1, further comprising controlling operation of the confinement apparatus to cause one of the atomic object being read or the at least one neighboring atomic object to oscillate in a second direction that is transverse to the first direction.
6. The method of claim 5, wherein when the atomic object being read emits stimulated emission in response to the reading beam being incident thereon, the stimulated emission is off resonance for the at least one neighboring atomic object.
7. The method of claim 1, wherein the confinement apparatus is operable to cause one of the atomic object being read or the at least one neighboring atomic object to oscillate in the first direction by applying at least one of a push force or an oscillating potential the one of the atomic object being read or the at least one neighboring atomic object.
8. The method of claim 1, further comprising: beginning to execute a quantum circuit using the at least two atomic objects within the atomic object confinement apparatus; during the performance of the quantum circuit, identifying a read function to be performed, wherein (a) the controlling operation of the confinement apparatus to cause one of the atomic object being read or the at least one neighboring atomic object to oscillate in the first direction and (b) the causing of the manipulation source to generate and provide the reading beam are performed responsive to identifying the read function to be performed; and continuing to execute the quantum circuit.
9. The method of claim 8, further comprising: receiving a read result responsive to the reading beam being incident at least in part on the atomic object being read; and adjusting the quantum circuit based at least in part on the read result such that the adjusted quantum circuit is executed.
10. The method of claim 1, wherein the first direction has a non-zero component in the reading beam direction.
11. A system comprising: a confinement apparatus configured to confine at least two atomic objects; a manipulation source to generate and provide a reading beam; and a controller configured to control operation of the confinement apparatus and the manipulation source, wherein the controller is configured to perform: causing the at least two atomic objects to be confined by the confinement apparatus, the at least two atomic objects comprising an atomic object being read and at least one neighboring atomic object; controlling operation of the confinement apparatus to cause one of the atomic object being read or the at least one neighboring atomic object to oscillate in a first direction; and causing the manipulation source to generate and provide the reading beam in a reading beam direction such that the reading beam is incident at least in part on the atomic object being read.
12. The system of claim 11, wherein the first direction has a non-zero component in the reading beam direction.
13. The system of claim 11, wherein the reading beam is resonant with a particular quantum transition of the atomic object being read.
14. The system of claim 11, wherein the atomic object being read oscillates in the first direction and a frequency of the reading beam is modulated so that in an oscillating reference frame of the atomic object being read, the reading beam is resonant with a particular quantum transition of the atomic object being read.
15. The system of claim 11, wherein the controller is further configured to perform controlling operation of the confinement apparatus to cause one of the atomic object being read or the at least one neighboring atomic object to oscillate in a second direction that is transverse to the first direction.
16. The system of claim 15, wherein when the atomic object being read emits stimulated emission in response to the reading beam being incident thereon, the stimulated emission is off resonance for

the at least one neighboring atomic object.

17. The system of claim 11, wherein the confinement apparatus is operable to cause one of the atomic object being read or the at least one neighboring atomic object to oscillate in the first direction by applying at least one of a push force or an oscillating potential the one of the atomic object being read or the at least one neighboring atomic object.

18. The system of claim 11, wherein the controller is further configured to perform: causing the system to begin executing a quantum circuit using the at least two atomic objects within the atomic object confinement apparatus; during the performance of the quantum circuit, identifying a read function to be performed, wherein (a) the controlling operation of the confinement apparatus to cause one of the atomic object being read or the at least one neighboring atomic object to oscillate in the first direction and (b) the causing of the manipulation source to generate and provide the reading beam are performed responsive to identifying the read function to be performed; and causing the system to continue executing the quantum circuit.

19. The system of claim 18, wherein the controller is further configured to perform: receiving a read result responsive to the reading beam being incident at least in part on the atomic object being read; and adjusting the quantum circuit based at least in part on the read result such that the adjusted quantum circuit is executed.

20. A controller operatively connected to one or more components of a system comprising a confinement apparatus and a manipulation source, the controller configured to: cause at least two atomic objects to be confined by the confinement apparatus, the at least two atomic objects comprising an atomic object being read and at least one neighboring atomic object; control operation of the confinement apparatus to cause one of the atomic object being read or the at least one neighboring atomic object to oscillate in a first direction; and cause the manipulation source to generate and provide a reading beam in a reading beam direction such that the reading beam is incident at least in part on the atomic object being read.
